and testing goals.[1] (Part of me wants to derive user authentication from first principles, and someday when I publish a book from "The Purist Press" I'll do that.)

Devise is a big, multifaceted gem, and I'll only be scratching the surface of what it can do. It handles all kinds of login needs, including confirmation emails, password changes, "remember me" cookies, and much more. First up, you need to put it in the Gemfile:

```
gem "devise"
```

As of this writing, the current version of Devise is 4.4.1.

After you install the gem with bundle install, you need to take two generation steps. The first is the general installation of the Devise setup:

```
$ rails generate devise:install
      create  config/initializers/devise.rb
      create  config/locales/devise.en.yml
```

This gives you a devise.rb initializer containing a lot of setup options that you aren't going to worry about at the moment, and a locale file containing all the static text Devise uses. You won't worry about that file, either.

At the end of the generation process, Devise gives you a useful list of a few tasks you need to do by hand to allow Devise to integrate with the application. The relevant tasks are as follows:

- In config/environments/development.rb, set some default mailer options by adding the suggested default line, config.action_mailer.default_url_options = { host: 'localhost:3000' }. In a real application you'd need that in your other environments as well, with the host pointing to the host URL.
- Give your config.routes.rb a root route—for example, by adding root to: "projects#index", which is the closest thing you have to a root route.
- Devise uses the Rails flash to distribute messages of success and failure. Add the following to app/views/layouts/application.html.erb any place in the file that seems relevant:

```
<p class="notice"><%= notice %></p>
<p class="alert"><%= alert %></p>
```

That's it. If you wanted to copy all of the Devise view code for the dialogs and stuff, you could also run rails generate devise:views from the command line. We'll skip that for now.

1. http://devise.plataformatec.com.br